A house style for technical whitepapers

A component specimen for web articles and printed research documents.

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This specimen demonstrates the approved typography, metadata, contents, figures, tables, equations and references. Its example values and diagrams are illustrative. Use it to select components; start a new paper from the shorter starter.

Start with the reader

A technical whitepaper needs to support two kinds of reading. A specialist may read the argument closely, checking assumptions and following the evidence. A decision-maker may begin with the summary, inspect a figure, and move directly to limitations or next steps. Both readers need a clear hierarchy and reliable references.

This example demonstrates the revised house style. The central prose column stays comfortable to read, while figures and tables have room to carry detail. Headings and paragraphs use Newsreader. Captions, tables and metadata use IBM Plex Sans.

One source, two reading modes

The web article provides a contents list and captions alongside figures when space allows. On small screens, the contents list collapses and captions move below their figures. The printed version uses a single column, captions below each figure, and page numbers.

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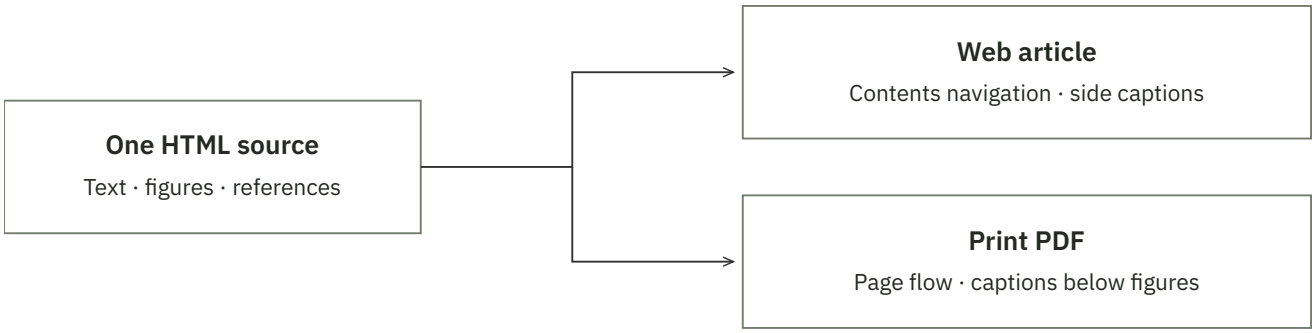


Figure 1. The document keeps one content source. Layout changes support the way each version is read. Vector artwork stays sharp in print and in the web lightbox.

A flexible opening

The metadata row always includes authors and a date. Without an optional label, those fields divide the row equally. A long author list receives approximately seventy percent of the width, leaving the rest for the date. Names wrap rather than shrinking.

An optional category identifies the document as a Research Paper, Technical Report, Concept of Operations, Case Study, White Paper, Analysis or Proposal. A custom label can describe a one-off document. Distribution is a separate optional field: Public, Internal, Proprietary or Confidential. Internal, Proprietary and Confidential also appear in the footer; Public does not.

The summary can sit on a very light background or remain unshaded. Both versions use the same typography and text. The distinction should be tested with the actual length of a document's summary.

Make technical information legible

A reader should be able to interpret a chart or table without repeatedly searching the prose for definitions. Put units in column headings, identify illustrative data, and give captions enough information to explain what the reader should notice.

Element	On the web	In the PDF
Contents	Sticky navigation on wide screens; collapsible on smaller screens	Optional one- or two-column index
Captions	Beside figures when space allows	Below figures
Prose	Controlled reading width	Narrower than the full figure width
Tables	Scrollable when needed on small screens	Headers repeat; rows stay together
Metadata	Responsive author, date and optional label fields	Same information, sized for the page

Table 1. Reading behavior changes between formats while the document's content remains the same.

Measure figure text at its final size

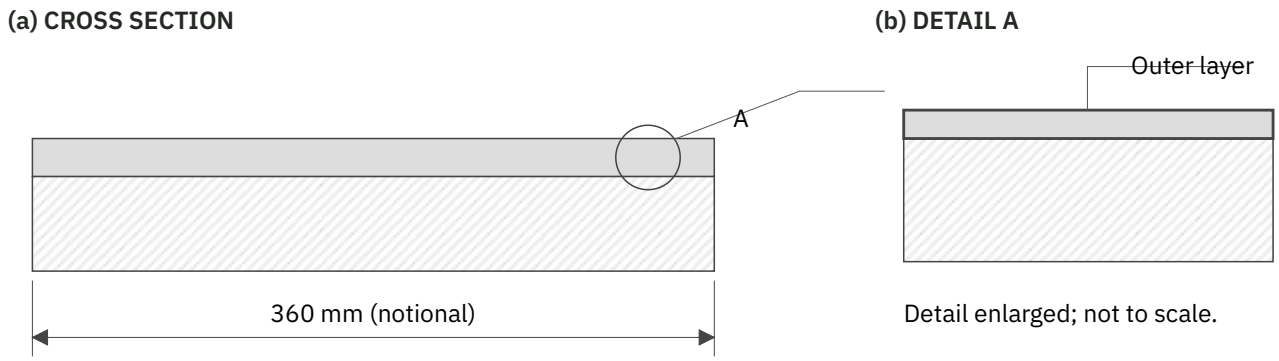
An SVG's drawing units are not printed points. For a figure with printed width W and viewBox width V, a label sized f in drawing units prints at:

$$f_{\text{print}} = \frac{W}{V} f \tag{1}$$

At a printed width of 496.8 points and a viewBox width of 700 units, a 12-unit label prints at approximately 8.5 points. Check the rendered PDF at reading size before deciding that a label is large enough.

Draft figures with a visual hierarchy

Figure 2 demonstrates dimensions, hatching and a detail view. Figure 3 demonstrates direct chart labels, line styles and a gray band. All geometry and values are illustrative; none represents measured system performance.



Notional geometry. Dimensions are illustrative.

Figure 2. Hatching distinguishes a substrate in grayscale. Thin dimension and leader lines remain subordinate to the emphasized outer layer; the enlarged detail explains the interface.

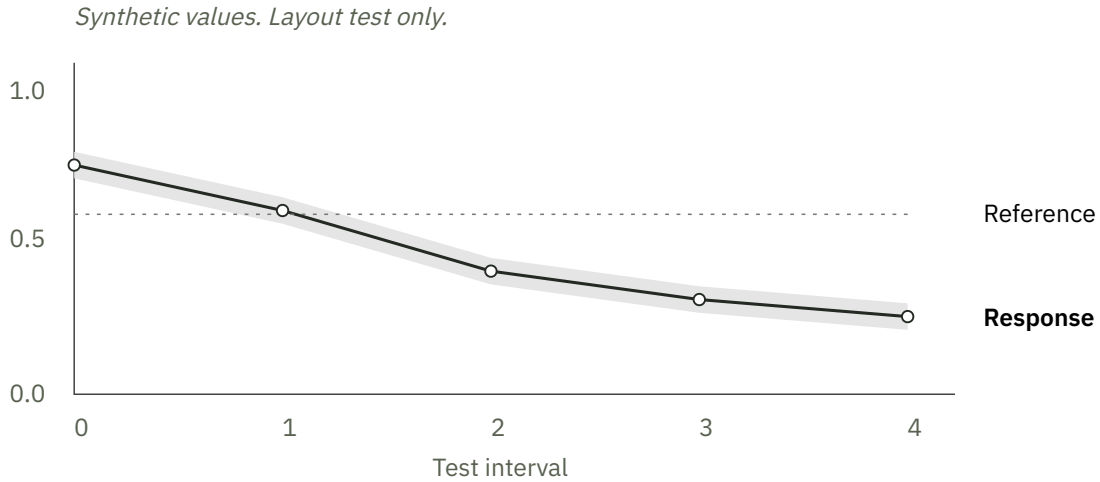


Figure 3. Direct labels identify the synthetic series and reference. Open circles, a gray band and a dotted line remain distinguishable without color. The band is a graphic example, not an estimated confidence interval.

Tables, lists and supporting notes

Table 2 uses grouped headings, aligned decimals and a narrow status column. Status marks need a text key. Large tables may continue across pages with repeated headers.

	Elapsed time (s)		
Configuration	**Median**	**95th percentile**	**Readiness**
Reference	12.40	17.80	○ Not tested
Candidate A	10.20	15.30	◐ Partial
Candidate B	11.60	16.10	● Complete

Table 2. Synthetic component comparison. Values demonstrate layout only.

Note: readiness is an illustrative qualitative scale, not a confidence estimate.

- Use bullets for parallel requirements or alternatives.
- Keep units with values and explain every symbol.

1. Prepare inputs.
2. Run the documented procedure.
3. Inspect the output and record limitations.

> WORKED EXAMPLE
>
> A record arrives after a fixed cutoff. Preserve its timestamp, report the lateness, and distinguish the late record from a missing record.

```
record = {"time": "2026-11-09T12:00:00Z", "value": 12.4}
assert record["value"] is not None
```

Raster images and scientific fields

Figure 4 uses a PNG to demonstrate a raster field. Preserve meaningful color and scales in real scientific maps; supply alt text and enough resolution for the final print size. This example is a synthetic grayscale field with arbitrary coordinates, not a measured weather product.

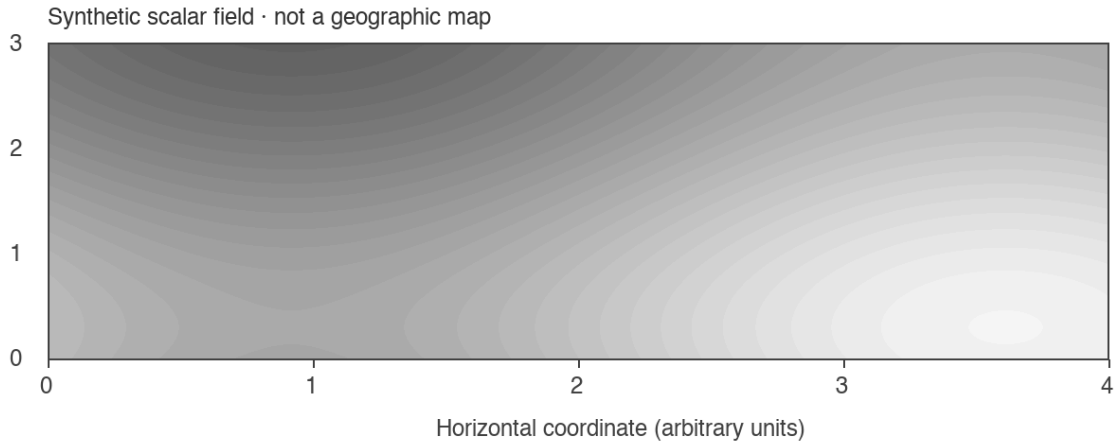


Figure 4. A raster image retains its original aspect ratio. The 1,400-pixel image provides about 200 pixels per printed inch at this width. These coordinates and tones have no geographic or physical interpretation.

Sources and appendices

Reference markers link to the source list and back to the point of use.[1] The long-report fixture exercises pagination with synthetic records.[2]

Appendix A. Supporting detail

Appendices follow normal page flow. Add a deliberate page break only when a particular document calls for a separate major part.

REFERENCES

1. WindBorne, *Whitepaper template specimen*, local component reference, Nov. 2026. Companion source: `specimen.html`.
2. WindBorne, *Long-report layout fixture*, synthetic test data and procedure descriptions, Nov. 2026. This is a testing artifact, not a research publication. Companion source: `stress-report.html`.